HYBRID AG
PRECISION NUTRITION

REVIEW DRAFT



HORTICULTURE / POST-HARVEST

Cherry post-harvest checklist

Post-harvest nutrition should reflect what the season has shown you. Work through these points with your agronomist to decide what needs correcting, how a DSA can inform the prescription and when to check the response.

01 Use this season's results to set priorities

- ☐ Use pack-out, fruit size and firmness results to focus the review on blocks where the nutrition plan may need to change. Consider crop load and seasonal conditions before attributing a result to nutrition.
- ☐ Review whether previous applications produced the expected change in test results or crop performance. Use that evidence when deciding what to repeat or change.
- ☐ Separate confirmed Nutrient limitations from suspected water, root or soil constraints before committing to further applications.

02 Use DSA to inform the next application

- ☐ Plan a post-harvest DSA while suitable leaf material remains active. Agree the timing with your agronomist for the variety, harvest date and condition of the block.
- ☐ Have the paired young and older leaf results interpreted alongside soil tests, other plant tests and recent applications. Establish which Nutrient findings warrant action and which need further investigation.
- ☐ If comparing repeated DSAs, check that sampling conditions and recent applications allow a useful comparison. Ask what has changed enough to justify adjusting the prescription.

03 Address priorities while leaves are active

- ☐ Agree which Nutrient requirements can usefully be addressed before leaf condition limits the opportunity for a response. Timing should follow the block's condition, rather than a fixed post-harvest date.
- ☐ Where the canopy is declining early, investigate irrigation, root and soil limitations before assuming an additional Nutrient application will resolve it.
- ☐ Match the application method and timing to the identified requirement and tree condition, without encouraging unnecessary late vegetative growth.

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A plan for your block

04 Set the prescription and the review

- ☐ Develop a Hybrid-Ag prescription around the requirements supported by the results. Agree where differences between blocks justify a different blend, rate or timing.
- ☐ Agree what a follow-up DSA or other assessment would need to show before continuing, adjusting or stopping an application.
- ☐ Carry unresolved soil constraints into the coming season's soil plan, with a clear next step for investigation or testing.

> DSA compares Nutrient concentrations in sap from different leaf ages. It informs the nutrition discussion; it does not directly measure stored carbohydrates, whole-tree reserves or Nutrient delivery to the fruit.

Priority limitation / evidence

DSA finding that changes the recommendation

Water / root / soil constraints to resolve

Prescription / rate / timing to agree

Expected response / how to assess it

Follow-up result / decision to review

Work through the post-harvest priorities with Josh.

Bring the test results and season's records you already have. Josh Richardson can discuss the next testing and prescription decisions with you. You can also register interest in a post-harvest webinar; dates and presenters are to be confirmed.

Hybrid-Ag Cherry Nutrition Playbook, Post-Harvest sections; Andrew Smith, Cherry Post Harvest presentation (29 March 2026); Hybrid-Ag Testing Guide 2026. Draft wording requires technical review before external use.